

Zoya Ahmer

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania | Philadelphia, PA

May 2025

Candidate for Bachelor of Arts

Major: Philosophy, Politics & Economics | *Concentration:* Globalization

Minors: Survey Research & Data Analytics | Latin American and Latinx Studies

Cumulative GPA: 3.89/4.0 | Honors: Dean's List, Pulitzer Center Reporting Fellow, Pi Sigma Alpha Political Science Honors Society (Vice President)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow, Yale Institution for Social and Policy Studies | New Haven, CT

Present

Penn Crime and Justice Policy Lab, *Making a Difference in Global Communities Fellow* | Philadelphia, PA

Jan. 2025-June 2025

Penn Program on Opinion Research and Election Studies, *NBC Decision Desk Fellow* | Philadelphia, PA

Aug. – Dec. 2024

- Assist with the NBC News Decision Desk during the 2024 United States general election, to collect precinct-level turnout data from county webpages all over the United States – which could prove critical for Decision Desk projections

Netter Center, *Participatory Action Design Studio Worker* | Philadelphia, PA

Jun. 2023 – Dec. 2024

- Design and develop curriculum materials for West Philadelphia educational institutions using Adobe InDesign, laser cutting, 3D printing, and more

HIAS Pennsylvania, *Legal Intern* | Philadelphia, PA

Jan – Aug. 2024

- Conducted 30–60-minute interviews for prospective clients in multiple languages, including demographic information, immigrant status, and review criteria for forms of legal relief to determine qualification for services and case type
- Collaborated with attorneys and law students to perform research and analysis for cases dealing with complex immigration issues such as U-visas, VAWA, asylum petitions, and more

Penn Program on Opinion Research and Election Studies, *R Tutor and NBC News Assistant* | Philadelphia, PA

Aug. – Dec. 2023

- Tutored 5-10 undergraduate students twice a week in political data science courses
- Aided students in learning R, data analysis, and presenting research
- Tracked outlets' websites and cable streams for race updates and calls on election nights for NBC

Penn Program on Opinion Research and Election Studies, *Research Fellow* | Philadelphia, PA

Jun. – Aug. 2023

- Conducted research with Professor Michael Morse and Marc Meredith to construct pre-analysis plan to measure burden of voter identification laws using novel administrative data generated by electronic pollbooks
- Used R to create multivariate models and data visualizations

Southern Coalition for Social Justice, *Data Science Intern* | Remote

Jan. – May 2023

- Conducted quantitative research, analysis, and spatial visualization of data in support of litigation and advocacy for voting rights and justice system reform
- Wrote R scripts to analyze NC election data that are still repurposed and re-used for subsequent elections

Nutritional Development Services, *Fox Fellow* | Philadelphia, PA

Jun. – Aug. 2022

- Provided on-site and over-the-phone training and technical assistance to site directors
- Headed communication with Philadelphia Health Department about school meals and handled administrative review preparation
- Cleaned and visualized P-EBT data, developed wellness policy resources, and created biweekly newsletter and social media posts messaging for schools and families about nutritious meals

National Immigrant Justice Center, *Communications and Marketing Intern* | Remote

Feb. – May 2022

- Created and implemented digital strategy and materials for NIJC's annual Human Rights Awards
- Marketed event via online and offline channels, developed printed and digital materials, coordinated with event sponsors and speakers, and made social media toolkits

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Languages: Spanish (Proficient)

Technical: R, Python, and SQL coding language, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office Suite

Interests: Piano, Running, Graphic Design, Video Production, Law, Public Policy, Global Health